

Rhetorical technique - Workbook 2

Focused practice - Workbook 2 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Heat Map

The report places two maps side by side: one shows tree canopy and the other shows afternoon surface temperature. Areas with less canopy often appear hotter.

1. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. visual comparison
- B. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- C. a chronological list of unrelated events
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

2. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. The side-by-side maps make the relationship between shade and surface temperature easier to notice.
- C. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- D. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.

Crosswalk Letter

"If children must cross this road every morning, should they have to guess whether drivers will stop?" asks a parent in a letter requesting a marked crosswalk.

3. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- B. a chronological list of unrelated events
- C. rhetorical question
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

4. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- C. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.
- D. The question challenges readers to consider the safety risk rather than seeking a literal answer.

Repair Story

A repair program brochure tells how one resident fixed a twenty-year-old fan for the cost of a small part instead of buying a new appliance.

5. Which rhetorical technique is most important in this example?

- A. anecdote / example
- B. a definition used only to introduce vocabulary
- C. a chronological list of unrelated events
- D. a neutral transition with no rhetorical effect

6. What does the technique accomplish in this text?

- A. It proves a broader claim that the example cannot establish.
- B. The example illustrates potential savings and makes the repair program's benefit concrete.
- C. It changes the topic instead of developing the writer's point.
- D. It adds decoration without affecting emphasis, clarity, or persuasion.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The writer uses visual comparison.
2. B. The side-by-side maps make the relationship between shade and surface temperature easier to notice.
3. C. The writer uses rhetorical question.
4. D. The question challenges readers to consider the safety risk rather than seeking a literal answer.
5. A. The writer uses anecdote / example.
6. B. The example illustrates potential savings and makes the repair program's benefit concrete.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.